

01 · SOFT-TISSUE INJURY

Hamstring Strain Recovery Protocol

A phase-by-phase guide for managing mild hamstring strains — from the first 72 hours through return to sport.

AUTHORED BY

Dorđe Ignjatović

Sport Rehabilitation Specialist

RECOVERY WINDOW

3 weeks – several months

THE THREE-PHASE PROTOCOL

1

PHASE ONE

Acute Management

0 – 72 HOURS

- Cryotherapy (cold application) to reduce inflammation
- Avoid any stretches that provoke pain
- Light, controlled movement within pain-free range
- Elevation of the leg and gentle muscle compression

2

PHASE TWO

Subacute Recovery

3 DAYS – 3 WEEKS

- Isometric exercises — contract without moving the joint
- Gradually increase pain-free range of motion
- Strengthen surrounding muscle groups (glutes, calves, core)
- Late phase: transition to concentric work (shortening under load)

3

PHASE THREE

Remodeling & Return

3 WEEKS – SEVERAL MONTHS

- Eccentric loading (lengthening under load) — critical at this stage
- Reintroduce running, then progressive change-of-direction drills
- Sport-specific hamstring drills and movement patterns



RED FLAGS — WHEN TO STOP & SEEK SPECIALIST CARE

Muscle injuries and recovery depend on many factors — degree of damage, location relative to the tendon attachment, and muscle-belly involvement. Rehab plans vary case by case, but these guidelines hold as a general framework.

Need a tailored program?

Get in touch for a personalized recovery and rehabilitation plan.

info@sportcaremed.com